Test 6:

READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.*

The Early History of Olive Oil

Olive oil is produced from the fruit of the olive tree, which is a member of the Oleaceae plant family. The trees require some cold weather during the year, but also tolerate hot, dry conditions, and do not like moisture when they are flowering. They actually produce better when subjected to these stressful conditions, and as a result, olive trees have traditionally been grown on land where little else will survive.

Archaeologists today are divided over exactly where the first domestication of the olive occurred: some say it was in the area which is now Iran, Syria, Jordan and Egypt, while others contend it was in mainland Greece or on the island of Crete. The one thing that can be said with certainty is that cultivation began at least 6,000 years ago and spread slowly westward across the lands bordering on the Mediterranean Sea. Olive oil was used for a variety of purposes during these early times, including as a pharmacological ointment and in rituals for anointing royalty.

The ancient Greeks believed the olive tree was a priceless gift from the goddess Athena and used its oil in sacred religious rituals. In fact, the Greek poet Homer called olive oil ‘liquid gold’, and during the 6th and 7th centuries BC, Greek law forbade the cutting down of olive trees and made it punishable by death. The ancient Middle Eastern ruler King David valued his groves of olive trees and his olive oil warehouses so much that he posted guards around the clock to protect them.

Over the years, olive oil developed other uses. Its employment in cooking dates at least as far back as the 5th century BC, as described by the Greek philosopher Plato. Its use as an aid to beauty and health later became ingrained in many Mediterranean cultures. The Romans, for example, are said to have used generous amounts on their bodies to moisturise their skin after bathing. With the spread of the Roman Empire, olive oil became a major commodity, and its trade promoted commerce throughout the ancient world. It is generally believed that in the 1st–2nd centuries BC, olive trees were taken to North Africa and then to Spain, which was later to become the world’s largest producer of olive oil. Artefacts found at various Mediterranean archaeological sites include olive oil storage vessels with olive plant residue still in them. Historical evidence still in existence in the form of wall paintings and ancient manuscripts (including the works of the Roman naturalist and philosopher, Pliny the Elder) all record production techniques and the various uses of olive oil.

Making olive oil in those early days was a laborious process accomplished without mechanisation. Processing or milling the fruit involved several distinct stages to extract the liquid. The olives were harvested from the trees by hand or by beating the fruit from the trees with long sticks. The olives were then rinsed and crushed to separate out the large seed found in the centre of each. The remaining seedless flesh was put in woven bags and pressed. Hot water was then poured over the bags to separate the oil from the solid bits of olive. The liquid produced in this process, consisting of oil and water, was drained into stone basins or tanks, where it was allowed to settle and separate. In cold weather, a bit of salt was added to speed up the process. As much oil as possible was drawn off the water, but the result was still not pure oil. Therefore, this impure mixture was allowed once more to settle in vats and then separated in order to refine the product.

The waste water from the milling process, which is called amurca, is a bitter-tasting and foul-smelling liquid. In many ancient civilisations it was often simply discarded, causing serious pollution because of its acidity and high salt content. However, in the Roman period it was regarded as a very useful substance. When spread on surfaces, amurca forms a hard finish and therefore it was often applied to the floors of grain storage buildings where it hardened, keeping out water, mud and pests. When boiled down, amurca was applied to leather to soften it so that it was easier to shape into articles of clothing and shoes. It could also be eaten by farm animals and was, in fact, fed to livestock suffering from malnutrition. According to ancient texts, amurca was also utilised in moderate amounts by farmers as a fertiliser or as a pesticide, helping them to protect their crops from insects and even small rodents.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

*In boxes **1–6** on your answer sheet, write:*

TRUE	if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE	if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN	if there is no information on this

1. In the cultivation of olives, a period without rain is advantageous.

2. The most fertile fields are usually chosen for growing olives.

3. In ancient Greece, the olive tree was said to have divine origins.

4. Olive oil was more costly to buy in Greece than gold.

5. Plato mentions the use of olive oil in the preparation of food.

6. North African farmers initially resisted the introduction of olive trees.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 7–9

Complete the flow-chart below.

*Write **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Ancient olive oil processing

Olives are harvested by picking them or **7** _____ the trees.

↓

Milling stage

↓

Olives are washed and crushed, and seeds removed.

↓

Olive flesh is placed in **8** _____ and pressed.

↓

Water is poured over the mixture.

↓

Resulting liquid is given time to settle and separate, and **9** _____ is used to aid the process.

↓

Oil is drawn off and separation repeated.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 10–13

Complete the notes below.

*Write **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Amurca

In ancient times, this waste liquid was usually thrown away, which led to **10** _____.

However, Romans had practical applications for amurca:

- when dried, created a hard surface, so used on **11** _____ of certain buildings
- used when making **12** _____ into goods to wear
- fed to livestock
- used on farms as a **13** _____ to stop insects or animals from damaging crops.

TRUE IELTS

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. TRUE – Văn bản nêu rõ cây ô liu chịu được điều kiện khô nóng và không thích độ ẩm khi đang ra hoa .

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The trees require some cold weather during the year, but also tolerate hot, dry conditions, and do not like moisture when they are flowering. They actually produce better when subjected to these stressful conditions.

2. FALSE – Cây ô liu truyền thống được trồng trên những vùng đất mà ít loài cây khác có thể sống sót, thay vì những cánh đồng màu mỡ nhất

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The trees require some cold weather during the year, but also tolerate hot, dry conditions, and do not like moisture when they are flowering. They actually produce better when subjected to these stressful conditions.

3. TRUE – Người Hy Lạp cổ đại tin rằng cây ô liu là món quà vô giá từ nữ thần Athena

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The trees require some cold weather during the year, but also tolerate hot, dry conditions, and do not like moisture when they are flowering. They actually produce better when subjected to these stressful conditions.

4. NOT GIVEN – Văn bản có nhắc Homer gọi dầu ô liu là "vàng lỏng" nhưng không so sánh giá mua thực tế của nó với vàng

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The trees require some cold weather during the year, but also tolerate hot, dry conditions, and do not like moisture when they are flowering. They actually produce better when subjected to these stressful conditions.

5. TRUE – Triết gia Hy Lạp Plato đã mô tả việc sử dụng dầu ô liu trong nấu ăn từ thế kỷ thứ 5 trước Công nguyên

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Its employment in cooking dates at least as far back as the 5th century BC, as described by the Greek philosopher Plato.

6. NOT GIVEN – Văn bản chỉ nói cây ô liu được đưa đến Bắc Phi nhưng không đề cập đến việc nông dân ở đó có phản đối hay không

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Its employment in cooking dates at least as far back as the 5th century BC, as described by the Greek philosopher Plato.

7. beating – Quả ô liu được thu hoạch bằng cách hái tay hoặc dùng gậy dài đập vào cây

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Its employment in cooking dates at least as far back as the 5th century BC, as described by the Greek philosopher Plato.

8. bags – Phần thịt quả sau khi bỏ hạt được cho vào các túi dệt để ép

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The remaining seedless flesh was put in woven bags and pressed.

9. salt – Trong thời tiết lạnh, một ít muối được thêm vào để đẩy nhanh quá trình tách dầu và nước

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The remaining seedless flesh was put in woven bags and pressed.

10. pollution – Việc vứt bỏ chất lỏng amurca gây ra ô nhiễm nghiêm trọng do tính axit và hàm lượng muối cao

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

The remaining seedless flesh was put in woven bags and pressed.

11. floors – Người La Mã bôi amurca lên sàn của các tòa nhà kho chứa ngũ cốc để tạo bề mặt cứng ngăn nước và sâu bọ

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

When spread on surfaces, amurca forms a hard finish and therefore it was often applied to the floors of grain storage buildings where it hardened.

12. leather – Amurca đun sôi được thoa lên da để làm mềm, giúp dễ tạo hình thành quần áo và giày dép

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

When spread on surfaces, amurca forms a hard finish and therefore it was often applied to the floors of grain storage buildings where it hardened.

13. pesticide (hoặc **fertiliser**) – Nông dân sử dụng một lượng vừa phải amurca làm thuốc trừ sâu để bảo vệ cây trồng khỏi côn trùng và động vật gặm nhấm

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

amurca was also utilised in moderate amounts by farmers as a fertiliser or as a pesticide helping them to protect their crops from insects and even small rodents.

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14-26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 on the following pages.*

Questions 14–18

*Reading Passage 2 has five sections, **A–E**.*

Choose the correct heading for each section from the list of headings below.

*Write the correct number, **i–vii**, in boxes 14–18 on your answer sheet.*

List of Headings

i Historical reasons why interrupted sleep became uncommon

ii Brain structures involved in sleep patterns

iii Potential health issues related to sleep

iv Famous cases in literature of sleep problems

v An analysis of old documents to discover sleep patterns

vi Biological and environmental factors preventing people from falling asleep again

vii Scientific evidence that divided sleep is a natural phenomenon

14 Section A

15 Section B

16 Section C

17 Section D

18 Section E

The Myth of the Eight-hour Sleep

A We often worry about lying awake in the middle of the night—but it could be good for you. Indications from both science and history suggest that the eight-hour sleep may not be a natural or inborn pattern for humans. In the early 1990s, psychiatrist Thomas Wehr conducted research which implies just that. Wehr kept a group of people in a darkened room for 14 hours a day for a month. It took some time for their sleep to regulate, but by the fourth week the subjects had settled into a very distinct sleeping pattern. First, they slept for four hours, then woke for one or two hours before falling into a second four-hour sleep. Though sleep scientists were impressed by the implications of the study, the idea that we must sleep for eight consecutive hours persists amongst the general public.

B In 2001, historian Roger Ekirch of Virginia Tech University in the US published a paper drawn from 16 years of research, revealing historical evidence that humans used to sleep in two distinct periods of time each night. Ekirch's research found more than 500 references to a segmented sleeping pattern—in diaries, court records, medical books and literature, from the ancient Greeks to tribes in Nigeria. Much like Wehr's findings, these references describe a first sleep which began not long following sunset. Then there was a waking period of one or two hours and after that a second sleep. During the waking period, people could be quite active. They sometimes got up and moved around the house, although most people stayed in bed, and perhaps read or wrote if they had enough money for candles. In many historic accounts, Ekirch found that people used the time that they were awake between periods of sleep to think about and attempt to analyse their dreams.

In his book, *Evening's Empire*, historian Craig Koslofsky suggests an explanation for this divided sleep pattern in Europe. 'Associations with night before the 17th century were not good,' he writes. He goes on to explain that the streets of the cities and towns at night were often populated by thieves or worse. The streets at night consequently scared many people. Even the wealthy, who could afford to light their way, had better things to spend their nights on.

C Ekirch found that references to the first and second sleep started to disappear during the late 17th century. The pattern began to alter first among the upper classes in northern Europe and, over the course of the next 200 years, began changing amongst the rest of Western society. By the 1920s, the idea of a first and second sleep had receded entirely from our social consciousness. Ekirch attributes the initial shift to improvements in street and home lighting.

As the night became a time for all kinds of activity, the length of time people slept declined. In 1667, Paris became the first city in the world to light its streets, using wax candles in glass lamps. It was followed by another French city, Lille, in the same year and by Amsterdam in Holland two years later, where a much more efficient oil-powered lamp was developed. London didn't light its streets until 1684, but by the end of the 17th century, more than 50 of Europe's major towns and cities were lit at night. Coffee houses emerged as a fashionable phenomenon and many were open virtually around the clock. Going out at night became commonplace, and spending hours lying in bed was considered a waste of time. 'People were becoming increasingly time-conscious and sensitive to efficiency, certainly before the 19th century,' says Ekirch. 'But the Industrial Revolution intensified that attitude considerably.' Strong evidence of this shifting attitude is contained in a medical journal from 1829 which urged parents to force their children out of the pattern of first and second sleep.

D Today, most people seem to have adapted quite well to the eight-hour sleep, but Ekirch believes many sleeping problems may have roots in the human body's natural preference for divided sleep, as well as in difficulties caused by extended exposure to artificial light in the modern world. This could be the cause of a condition called sleep maintenance insomnia, where people wake during the night and have trouble getting back to sleep. The condition first appears in literature at the end of the 19th century, at the same time as accounts of interrupted sleep disappear.

E Sleep psychologist Gregg Jacobs says that the idea that we must sleep for an extended period of time could be damaging if it makes people who wake up in the night anxious, as this anxiety can itself discourage sleep and is likely to affect waking life too. Jacobs suggests that the waking period between sleeps, when people simply rested and relaxed, could have played an important part in the human capacity to regulate stress naturally. Russell Foster, a professor of circadian (body clock) neuroscience at Oxford University in the UK, shares this point of view. 'Over 30% of the medical problems that doctors are faced with stem directly or indirectly from sleep. But sleep has been ignored in medical training, and there are very few centres where sleep is studied,' Foster says. He feels this needs to change.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 19–23

Look at the following statements (Questions 19–23) and the list of researchers below.

Match each statement with the correct researcher, ***A–E****.*

Write the correct letter, ***A–E****, in boxes 19–23 on your answer sheet.*

NB *You may use any letter more than once.*

19 In certain historical periods, the threat of criminal danger led to segmented sleep.

20 Physicians should learn more about treating people with sleeping difficulties.

21 Historically, when people experienced interrupted sleep, they used the waking periods at night for different activities.

22 Technological changes in Europe made people more likely to sleep through the night.

23 The belief that humans should have a long continuous sleep can be psychologically harmful.

TRUE IELTS

List of Researchers

A Thomas Wehr

B Roger Ekirch

C Craig Koslofsky

D Gregg Jacobs

E Russell Foster

Questions 24–26

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 24–26 on your answer sheet.

Historical patterns of interrupted sleep

Historical evidence seems to show that humans had common sleep patterns which were quite unlike today's eight hours of unbroken sleep each night. People habitually went to bed early, soon after **24** _____, slept for a while, then woke up for a few hours of activity or perhaps to consider, for example, the meaning of their **25** _____.

There was little else to do at home in the dark, since what little means of lighting they had, such as using candles, was costly. In 16th-century Europe, people tended to stay at home at night because they feared **26** _____ on largely unlit city streets. Once urban street lighting improved, nightlife in cities became popular, and recreational spots like coffee houses came to be considered fashionable. Consequently, sleeping patterns also began to change.

TRUE IELTS

ĐÁP ÁN:

14. Section A: vii (Bằng chứng khoa học cho thấy giấc ngủ chia đoạn là một hiện tượng tự nhiên)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

In the early 1990s, psychiatrist Thomas Wehr conducted research which implies just that Wehr kept a group of people in a darkened room or 14 hours a day for a month. It took some time for their sleep to regulate, but by the fourth week the subjects had settled into a very distinct sleeping pattern. Firstly, they slept four hours, then woke for one or two hours before falling into a second four-hour sleep.

15. Section B: v (Phân tích các tài liệu cũ để khám phá các kiểu ngủ - nhật ký, hồ sơ tòa án...)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

In 2001, historian Roger Ekirch of Virginia Tech University in the US published a paper drawn from 16 years of research, revealing historical evidence that humans used to sleep in two distinct periods of time each night.

16. Section C: i (Các lý do lịch sử khiến giấc ngủ bị gián đoạn trở nên không phổ biến - sự ra đời của đèn đường, cách mạng công nghiệp)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Ekirch found that references to the first and second sleep started to disappear during the late 17th century. The pattern began to alter first among the urban upper classes changing amongst the rest of Western society. By the 1920s, the idea of a first and second sleep had receded entirely from our social consciousness. Ekirch attributes the initial shift to improvements in street and home lighting. As the night became a time for all kinds of activity, the length of time people used for rest declined.

17. Section D: vi (Các yếu tố sinh học và môi trường ngăn cản mọi người ngủ lại - ánh sáng nhân tạo, thói quen sinh học)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

but Ekirch believes many sleeping problems may have roots in the human body's natural preference for divided sleep, as well as in difficulties caused by extended exposure to artificial light in the modern world.

18. Section E: iii (Các vấn đề sức khỏe tiềm ẩn liên quan đến giấc ngủ - lo âu, căng thẳng)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

'Over 30% of the medical problems that doctors are faced with stem directly or indirectly from sleep. But sleep has been ignored in medical training, and there are very few countries where sleep is studied,' Foster says. He feels this needs to change.

19. C (Craig Koslofsky: Trong các thời kỳ lịch sử nhất định, mối đe dọa từ tội phạm dẫn đến giấc ngủ chia đoạn)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

In his book, Evening's Empire, historian Craig Koslofsky suggested an explanation for this divided sleep pattern in Europe. 'Associations with night before the 17th century were not good,' he writes.

20. E (Russell Foster: Các bác sĩ nên tìm hiểu thêm về việc điều trị cho những người gặp khó khăn về giấc ngủ)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

'Over 30% of the medical problems that doctors are faced with stem directly or indirectly from sleep. But sleep has been ignored in medical training, and there are very few countries where sleep is studied,' Foster says.

21. B (Roger Ekirch: Trong lịch sử, khi mọi người ngủ ngắt quãng, họ sử dụng thời gian thức để làm các hoạt động khác nhau)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Then there was a waking period of one or two hours and after that a second sleep. During the waking period, people could be quite active. They sometimes got up and moved around

the house, although most people stayed in bed, and perhaps read or wrote if they had enough money for candles.

22. B (Roger Ekirch: Những thay đổi công nghệ ở Châu Âu làm cho mọi người có xu hướng ngủ xuyên đêm hơn)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

By the 1920s, the idea of a first and second sleep had receded entirely from our social consciousness. Ekirch attributes the initial shift to improvements in street and home lighting.

23. D (Gregg Jacobs: Niềm tin rằng con người nên ngủ một giấc dài liên tục có thể gây hại về mặt tâm lý)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Sleep psychologist, Gregg Jacobs, says that the idea that we must sleep for an extended period of time could be changing. If it makes people who wake up in the night anxious, as this anxiety can itself discourage sleep and is likely to affect waking life too.

24. sunset (Mọi người thường đi ngủ sớm, ngay sau khi **mặt trời lặn**)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Much like Wehr's findings, these references describe a first sleep which began not long following sunset.

25. dreams (...hoặc có lẽ để xem xét ý nghĩa của những **giấc mơ** của họ)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

In many historic accounts, Ekirch found that people used the time that they were awake between periods of sleep to think about and attempt to analyse their dreams.

26. thieves (Ở Châu Âu thế kỷ 16, mọi người có xu hướng ở nhà vào ban đêm vì họ sợ **trộm cướp** trên những con phố không đèn)

He goes on to explain that the streets of cities and towns at night were often populated by thieves or worse. The streets at night consequently scared many people.

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 3

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 27-40, which are based on Reading Passage 3.

The New Zealand writer Margaret Mahy

In a career spanning some fifty years, Margaret Mahy has come to occupy a unique place in New Zealand writing with innovative fiction and original characterisation. In our solidly realist tradition, the linguistic fireworks of Mahy's children's fiction and the explorations of human behaviour at the heart of her supernatural teenage fiction stand gloriously alone. Mahy's clearest heir, I have always thought, is Elizabeth Knox — and maybe the true inheritance there is sheer singularity. Just as there is no one else like Knox in New Zealand writing, Mahy, too, has ventured into imaginative territory unknown to other local writers. So it was with great pleasure that I visited Mahy recently at her Governor's Bay home to talk about her new book. As with all journalists, she is generous to a fault with her time and attention; and, as always — despite her careful consideration of questions and thoughtful answers — I'm reminded she isn't truly comfortable making herself or her life the heart of any conversation.

Certainly, any consideration of the style of Mahy's novels and picture books throws up some irresistible theories. As a writer committed to supporting herself through her art, she has seldom had the time for formal research. Rather, it has been a matter of going out and finding inspiration from her immediate environment: the writing on the side of a bus; a spelling mistake in a note to herself; the similarity between a cat and a fur hat. But despite these sometimes mundane origins, the settings for her stories are delightfully varied, as these books celebrate the dramatic plot twists and unpredictability of adventures on the high seas or in Antarctica, and also in quite unassuming places like the library or even down the back of a chair at home. Mahy has a lifelong affection for characters who are agents of upheaval and disturbance. Her junior and picture books are peppered with pirates, robbers and lions, though they appear alongside librarians, mothers and children, working against comfortable stereotype. Her fictions often have at their heart a young adult burdened with special powers, such as the ability to cast spells in order to transform their world in supernatural and fantastical ways. Another common feature is that, while the conclusions of her tales are usually predictable, they leave the reader feeling absolutely complete, the moral questions resulting from our hero's powers having been resolved.

Many of these themes can be found in her new novel, *The Magician of Hoad*. The book was begun more than 15 years ago and envisioned as an 'entire' fantasy — one set in a fully imagined world with detailed history and complex tribal inter-relationships, a classical hero quest at its heart. The story ballooned at one point to 800 pages and has been through at least two substantial rewrites. Now half its original size, it is a fascinating read — an adventure, a romance, and a gold mine of Mahy literary preoccupations.

The other splendid Mahy publication this year is a re-issue of *Bubble Trouble* in a now-illustrated edition. This tongue-twister tale first appeared in 1991, was included in *100 New Zealand Poems* (1993) and has been recited by Mahy at countless private and public functions. Perhaps more than any other work, *Bubble Trouble* is the Mahy that New Zealand

children and their parents know so well, the rollicking story of a clown who serves up a joyous torrent of word-play and unexpected rhyme.

Those connections are four or five deep now. I read *The Lion in the Meadow* in the *School Journal* in the late 1960s; my step-daughter listened to *The Boy Who Was Followed Home* over and over in the 1970s; my own children sat very still mouthing *The Great White Man-Eating Shark* in the 80s and 90s; now, in the 21st century, my grandchildren have heard *Down the Dragon's Tongue*, *A Summery Saturday Morning* and *Dashing Dog* many times.

Of course, readers are important to any working writer, but Mahy's espousal of the act of reading goes beyond that: a book is not properly finished, she has often said, until it has been read, because a reader brings something important to the book. So, doubtless out of need to build a market — she's not ignorant of her popularity — but also out of genuine care for that other dynamic part of the author-reader relationship, Mahy has, until recently, kept up a punishing schedule of public appearances.

Private conversation with Mahy has always been a wild ride — marvellous, in the true sense of the word, the product of a hungry head and an infinite capacity to be astonished. She races away at one stage to consult an encyclopaedia for L. M. Montgomery's date of death, and speculates about the 'real' Montgomery, creator of the ever-popular *Anne of Green Gables*. Although I'd come to talk about her new book, I couldn't help but be captivated by her infectious curiosity.

A few years ago, the writer David Hill told a funny story. Though his writing was, he conceded, very different from Mahy's, he had been affected by her peculiarly alert way of looking at the world, particularly the mad, slippery life of language. Once, Hill said, in a motel room, a sign on a door caught his eye: 'This door is alarmed.' Mahy would like that, thought Hill. She would enjoy the comedy just below the surface of the formal warning; she would leap immediately to the possibilities for story and language play: 'Yes, and this window is concerned, this light fitting is irritated.' His story was a wonderful comment on Mahy's vision.

Questions 27–31

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 27–31 on your answer sheet, write

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer*
NO *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer*
NOT GIVEN *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

27 Mahy explores the traditional themes of New Zealand literature.

28 Mahy's children's books have been more popular than her teenage books.

29 Mahy and Knox have sometimes criticised each other's work.

30 Mahy is welcoming to interviewers.

31 Mahy is at ease speaking about her experiences.

Questions 32–35

Complete the summary below using the list of words and phrases A–I.

Write the correct letter A–I in boxes 32–35 on your answer sheet.

Theories about Mahy's style

Mahy's determination to earn a living from writing has encouraged her to find the ideas for her work in **32** _____ places. The stories themselves are set in locations that are **33** _____. In terms of characterisation, almost all of her books feature unruly people, and very often an adolescent who possesses **34** _____ abilities. Finally, the endings of the stories tend to be **35** _____.

A disruptive and unpredictable	**B** everyday	**C** loveable
D controversial	**E** exotic and ordinary	**F** isolated
G unconfident	**H** unsurprising but satisfying	**I** magical

Questions 36 – 40

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

Write the correct letter A–D in boxes 36–40 on your answer sheet.

36 What does the writer say about *The Magician of Hoad*?

A It is partly based on true history.
B It was restructured in the writing process.
C It is quite different from conventional stories.
D It does not reflect the usual themes of Mahy's work.

37 According to the writer, Bubble Trouble

A was first illustrated in 1991.
B is written in plain language.
C is an old favourite for many families.
D has not been read aloud by Mahy before.

38 The writer's purpose in the fifth paragraph is to

A show how Mahy's style has changed through generations.
B criticise Mahy's children's stories for being repetitive.
C describe how new media have changed entertainment.
D illustrate Mahy's popularity with generations of children.

39 According to the sixth paragraph, which of the following is true?

A Readers sometimes do not finish Mahy's books.
B Mahy actively encourages feedback from readers.
C Readers are necessary in order to complete a book.
D Mahy does not realise how important she is to some readers.

40 What is the writer doing in the final paragraph?

A illustrating Mahy's view of the world
B comparing Mahy with another writer
C correcting a misconception about Mahy
D suggesting reasons for Mahy's approach

ĐÁP ÁN:

27. NO

Giải thích: Tác giả nhấn mạnh Mahy đã tiến vào những vùng lãnh thổ tưởng tượng mà các nhà văn địa phương khác "chưa biết đến", khác biệt hoàn toàn với truyền thống hiện thực (realist tradition) vững chắc của New Zealand. (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

28. NOT GIVEN

Giải thích: Bài đọc đề cập đến cả truyện thiếu nhi và truyện cho thiếu niên nhưng không so sánh mức độ phổ biến giữa hai loại này. (91. P3 - T... p. 5)

29. NOT GIVEN

Giải thích: Chỉ có thông tin Elizabeth Knox là "người kế thừa" rõ rệt nhất của Mahy, không có thông tin về việc họ phê bình tác phẩm của nhau. (91. P3 - T... p. 5)

30. YES

Giải thích: Văn bản mô tả bà "generous to a fault" (hào phóng đến mức quá đáng) về thời gian và sự chú ý đối với các nhà báo/người phỏng vấn. (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

31. NO

Giải thích: Tác giả cho biết bà "không thực sự thoải mái" (isn’t truly comfortable) khi đưa bản thân hoặc cuộc đời mình làm tâm điểm của cuộc trò chuyện. (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

32. B (everyday)

Giải thích: Ý tưởng cho các tác phẩm của bà đến từ môi trường xung quanh tức thì như dòng chữ bên hông xe buýt hoặc một lỗi chính tả. (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

33. E (exotic and ordinary)

Giải thích: Bối cảnh truyện rất đa dạng, từ những nơi xa xôi như Nam Cực (exotic) đến những nơi bình dị như thư viện hay sau lưng ghế (ordinary). (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

34. I (magical)

Giải thích: Nhân vật chính thường là thanh thiếu niên sở hữu những khả năng đặc biệt như làm phép (cast spells). (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

35. H (unsurprising but satisfying)

Giải thích: Kết thúc truyện thường có thể dự đoán trước (predictable) nhưng lại khiến người đọc cảm thấy hoàn toàn trọn vẹn (complete). (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

36. B (It was restructured in the writing process)

Giải thích: Cuốn *The Magician of Hoad* từng dài tới 800 trang và đã trải qua ít nhất hai lần viết lại đáng kể, giờ chỉ còn một nửa kích thước ban đầu. (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

37. C (is an old favourite for many families)

Giải thích: Tác phẩm này được trẻ em và phụ huynh New Zealand biết đến rất rõ và đã được Mahy đọc tại vô số sự kiện. (91. P3 - T... pp. 1, 5)

38. D (illustrate Mahy's popularity with generations of children)

Giải thích: Tác giả liệt kê các kết nối từ những năm 1960 qua các thế hệ con, cháu để cho thấy sự yêu mến xuyên suốt thời gian. (91. P3 - T... pp. 2, 5)

39. C (Readers are necessary in order to complete a book)

Giải thích: Mahy tin rằng một cuốn sách chưa thực sự hoàn thành cho đến khi nó được đọc, vì độc giả mang lại điều gì đó quan trọng cho cuốn sách. (91. P3 - T... pp. 2, 5)

40. A (illustrating Mahy's vision)

Giải thích: Câu chuyện về tấm biển "This door is alarmed" được dùng để minh họa cho cách nhìn nhận thế giới và sự nhạy bén ngôn ngữ đặc biệt của Mahy. (91. P3 - T... pp. 2, 5)